First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

**Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.***

### First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

### First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

**Please feel free to contact us:**
Administrative Office: Monday: 2pm-4pm; Tuesday 9am-2pm; Wednesday 10am-Noon; Thursday 9am-2pm; Friday 10am-Noon.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

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**Our worship service** is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Valarie Walden

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.




***"We welcome you and serve all through faith."***

***Worship with us:***

***March 10, 2024***

***10 am***

*Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor*
*Stephan Conrady, Organist*
*Dr. Kevin Dirth, Choir Director*
*Monica Newton, Office Manager*

*27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478*
*802-524-4555*
*info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org*
*www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org*

Fourth Sunday In Lent March 10, 2024

## *We Gather as God's People*

Centering Words**:**
"Don't condemn me, but think of me as a person who sometimes reaches the bursting point!" — Anne Frank

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

**THE PREPARATION**

*The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.*

Prelude

Welcome and Announcements

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

**O God who is Friend, the vastness of your love flows through all of creation, and this is cause for rejoicing. For all the harshness and condemnation that we see in the world, you have come to us out of love, compassion, and to save us from ourselves. We acknowledge our belief that you have come to redeem, to heal, to restore, and forgive, not just some of the world, but all of the world. May our worship embody the love and light you bring in Jesus, in whose name we pray. Amen.**

Hymn*

***"Precious Lord Take My Hand"*** NCH 472

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Litany)**

**Holy One, we confess there are moments when we desire to see you bring condemnation on others or wish that your love was not for the whole world, but just a few. Like us. But, your love is bigger than our limited lenses, broader than our small scope of vision of all that love embodies. Help us to see the world as you do. Help us to love as you do. Release us from our need to condemn and set us free for love. Amen.**



**Welcome to all visitors:** We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

**After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.**

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

**Announcements:**

**A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:**

- ★ **Stephen McLaughlin Thank You for playing guitar today while Stephan is away!**
- ★ **Discretionary Funders- you know who you are! Thank You for the recent infusion to the Pastor's Discretionary Fund! We were able to help someone get to rehab this week!**

**Holy Week Schedule**
**March 24 at 10am**
Palm Sunday --marks our return to the Sanctuary!
**March 28 at 6:30pm**
Maundy Thursday Pot-Luck and Tennebrae Service
**March 31:**
**6:30am** Sunrise Easter Service at Hard'Ack with St. Paul's and St. Luke's
**10:00am** Easter Service at 10am in the Sanctuary

**Music Notes:**
John Newton, the writer of today's anthem was born in 1725 in England. Mr. Newton was a former sea captain, clergyman and poet. He was also a slave trader. He wrote Amazing Grace in 1772 when he was a clergyman. As he states in the hymn, he was a wretch, but God found him. He was saved by God's amazing grace. The hymn also conveys a powerful message that speaks to all people: there is the possibility for relief from life's trials and tribulations where one can live a joyful and peaceful life.

**Wi-Fi:**
Fellowship Hall
fellowshiphall123






Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

**THE MESSAGE**

Anthem *Amazing Grace* John Newton

Scripture Readings

Numbers 21:4-9 & John 3:1-21

Morning Reflection

Big Enough

Hymn*

***"Let Us Break Bread Together"*** NCH 330

**THE COMMUNION**

One: The invitation is simple: come and eat of the feast. Not a meal to nourish the body, but to feed the soul. We receive the bread and juice connected to the ages: to the saint of old who felt unworthy, to the seeker eager to know God, to the one who wonders what it's all about, to the one who eats with unburdened faith. Woven into this time are the hopes and tears of generations. There is great joy here. No one is turned away for God is the host! May the peace of the Lord be with you always.

**All: And also with you.**
One: Lift up your hearts.
**All: We lift them up to the Lord.**
One: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.
**All: It is right to give God thanks and praise.**

Pause

**All: Loving God, recalling Christ's gracious life and death, and proclaiming the resurrection, we offer this bread and cup.**

**Send your Holy Spirit upon us and upon these gifts, that they may be for us the body and blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, and being built up by this precious sacrament of grace, we may receive the gift of eternal life in the blessed and heavenly realm.**

One: We ask this in the name of Jesus Christ, praying the prayer taught to the disciples:

***All: Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil, for thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever. Amen.***

One: Gathered with his friends, Jesus took bread, broke it and said, "This is my body, broken for you. Take and eat."

And Jesus took the juice and said, "This is my blood, spilled out for you. Do this in remembrance of me."

**Distribution of the Bread and Cup**: please hold your cup until we serve all, so that all may drink together.

One: Let us pray.

**All: Gracious God, we thank you for refreshing us at your table. May we who share Christ's bread live his risen life.**

**May we who drink Christ's cup bring abundant life to others. May the Holy Spirit who lights the world also enlighten our lives. Strengthen in us the hope you set before us, so that we and all your children shall be free, and so that the whole earth may live to praise your name. Amen.**



## THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Pastor's Prayer~ Lord's Prayer

**Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.**

## OFFERTORY

Doxology

***Praise God from whom all blessing flow***
***Praise God all creatures here below;***
***Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:***
***Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.***

Offertory Prayer

## THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

***"Go Now in Peace"***

***Go now in peace, never be afraid***
***God will be with you each hour of every day***

***Go now in faith, steadfast, strong and true***
***Know he will guide you in all you do.***

***Go now in love, and show you believe***
***Reach out to others so all the world can see***

***God will be there, watching from above***
***Go now in peace, in faith, and in love.***

***Amen. (X3)***

Benediction

Postlude

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖